

WhatToEat User Instruction Manual

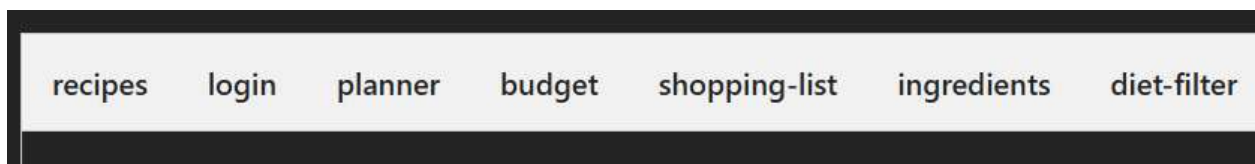
Contents

- 1 Navigation**
- 2 Accessing Recipes**
- 3 User Login/Registration**
- 4 Recipe Planner**
- 5 AI Recommendations**
- 6 Shopping List**
- 7 Diet Filter**
- 8 Ingredient Tracker**

1 Navigation -----

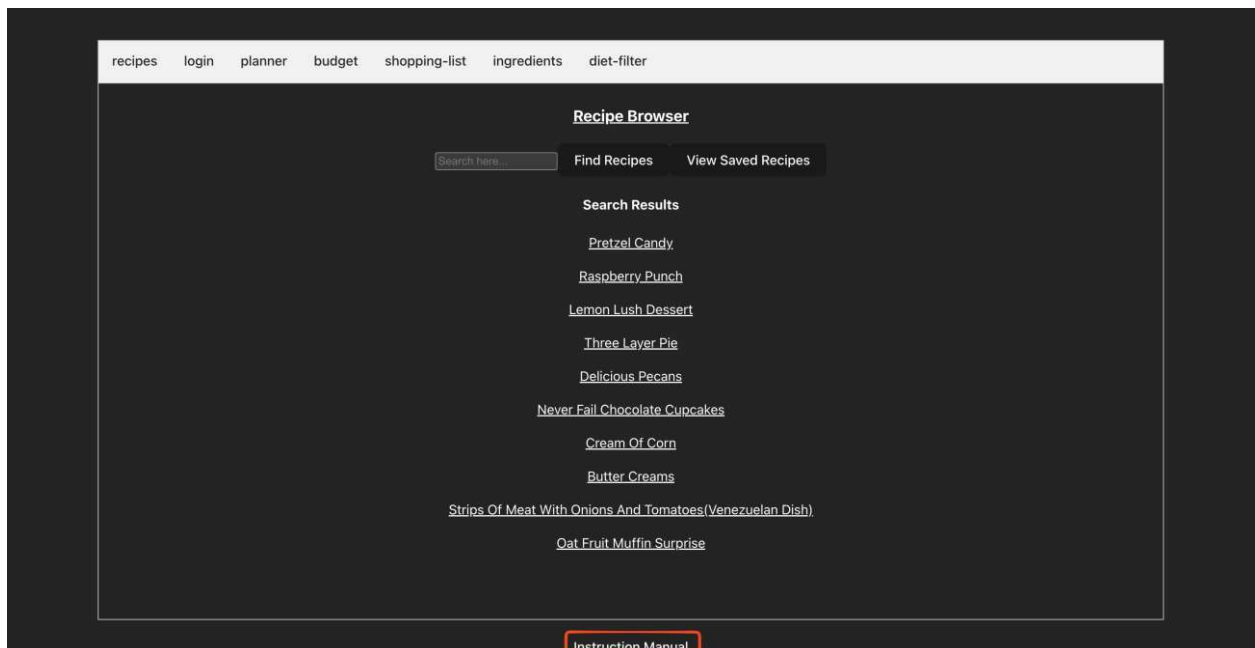
1.1 Feature Tabs

To navigate around the website, click on any of the available tabs that are presented on the top of the screen, as shown below. To select any given tab, click on it, and it will direct the user to the desired page with the matching feature. These tabs provide access to each individual feature available on the website, and they are located at the top of every page on the website for easy access.



1.2 Accessing the Instruction Manual from the Website

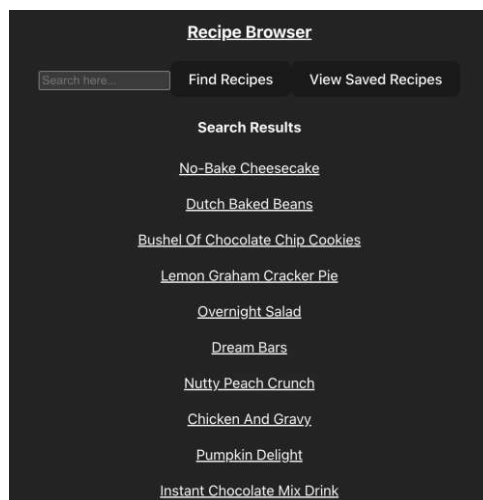
To access this instruction manual for future reference, the user can click on the “Instruction Manual” button at the bottom of the website (highlighted in red)



2 Accessing Recipes

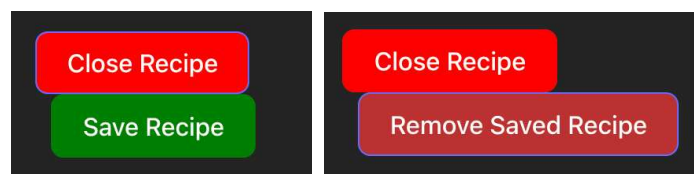
2.1 Recipe Browser Page

On the homepage screen in the top left corner, there will be a “recipe” tab that directs users to the Recipe Browser Page. To know that you are on this page, there will be a title of “Recipe Browser” located at the top of the page. On this page, there is a search bar that allows the user to see the recipes of the ingredients they put in the search bar, and below the search bar will follow a list of 10 recipes to further look at. To search for recipes, input the desired ingredient and select the “Find Recipes” button next to the search bar. After selecting the button, 10 recipes will be listed.



2.2 Saving Recipes

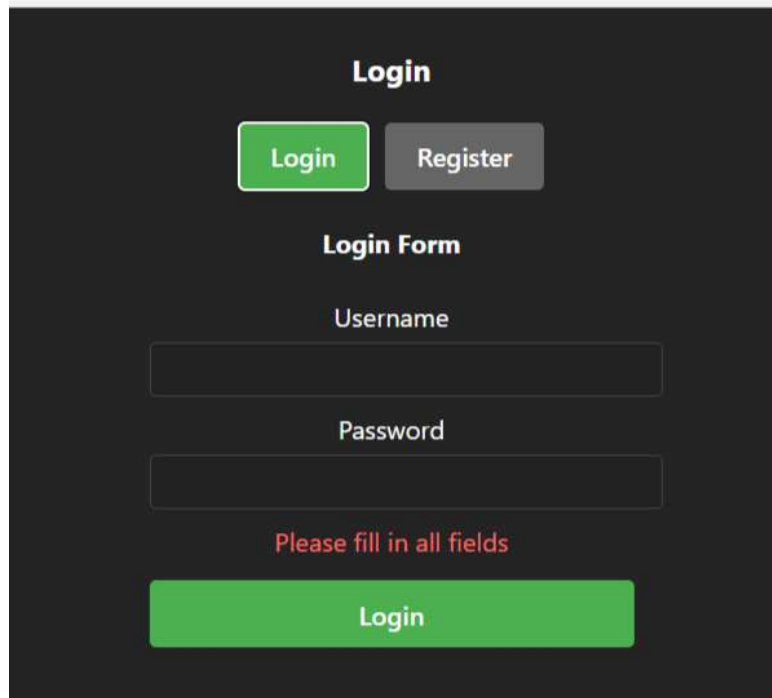
When selecting a recipe from the recipe browser, the recipe appears with ingredients, step-by-step instructions, and a link to the original recipe website for reference. A button will also appear in the top left corner that allows the user to save a recipe. If the user clicks the “Save Recipe” button, then that recipe will be saved for future reference, and can be accessed by clicking the “View Saved Recipes” button on the Recipe Browser homepage. Upon clicking this button again (when it says “Remove Saved Recipe”), the recipe will be removed from the list of saved recipes.



3 User Login/Registration -----

3.1 Login Page

In the top left corner of the list of tabs, there will be one named “login,” which directs users to the login page. When inside the login page, there will be two buttons named “Login” and “Register” that both perform their own actions. If the user stays on the login page, they will have access to fill in the login form containing the user's provided username and password. If the user does not have the correct credentials, is not a valid user, or is not a register user and attempts to use the login page will be denied access and will be directed to “fill in all required fields.”

The image shows a dark-themed login interface. At the top, the word "Login" is centered in white. Below it are two buttons: a green "Login" button and a grey "Register" button. Under these buttons is the heading "Login Form" in white. This is followed by two input fields: "Username" and "Password", each with a light grey border. Below the input fields is a red error message that says "Please fill in all fields". At the bottom of the form is a large green "Login" button.

NOTE: This page will only work if the user has logged in prior and saved account information.

3.2 Register Form

Still inside the login tab, there is another button next to the Login, labeled “Register,” which brings users to the registration form. In the register form, there will be three fields the user must fill out; their username, password, and a confirmation password. By filling out the fields the user is creating their username and password for their future account that they will be identified by.

Login

Login Register

Register Form

Username

Password

Confirm Password

Please fill in all fields

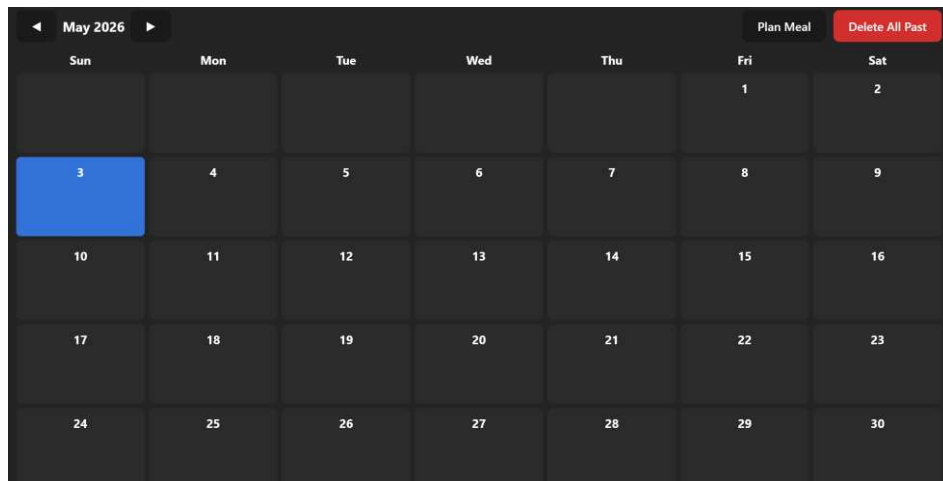
Register

NOTE: If the user wants a valid account, they must complete this form before anything else.

4 Recipe Planner-----

4.1 Planner page

The planner page is accessed through the “planner” tab and directs users to a virtual calendar. It is designed to have the features a typical virtual calendar would have, such as creating events.

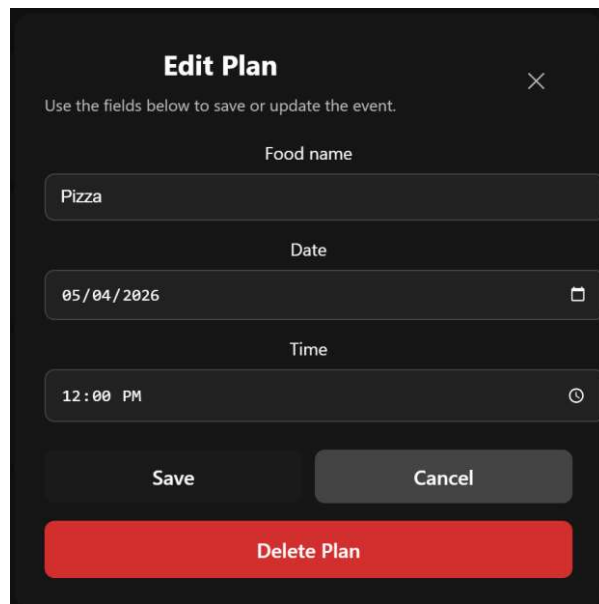


4.2 Using the Meal Planner

To plan a meal, click on the button that says, “Plan Meal” OR click on a box in the calendar. From there, the user may write the name of a food they want to eat and when they want to eat it. The food will appear on the calendar after clicking “Save”.

A screenshot of a 'Plan Meal' modal form. The form has a title 'Plan Meal' and a close button (X). Below the title is a subtitle 'Use the fields below to save or update the event.' The form contains three input fields: 'Food name' with a placeholder 'Food name', 'Date' with a value '05/04/2026' and a calendar icon, and 'Time' with a value '12:00 PM' and a clock icon. At the bottom are two buttons: 'Save' and 'Cancel'.

The user may edit or delete a planned food by clicking on it in the calendar.



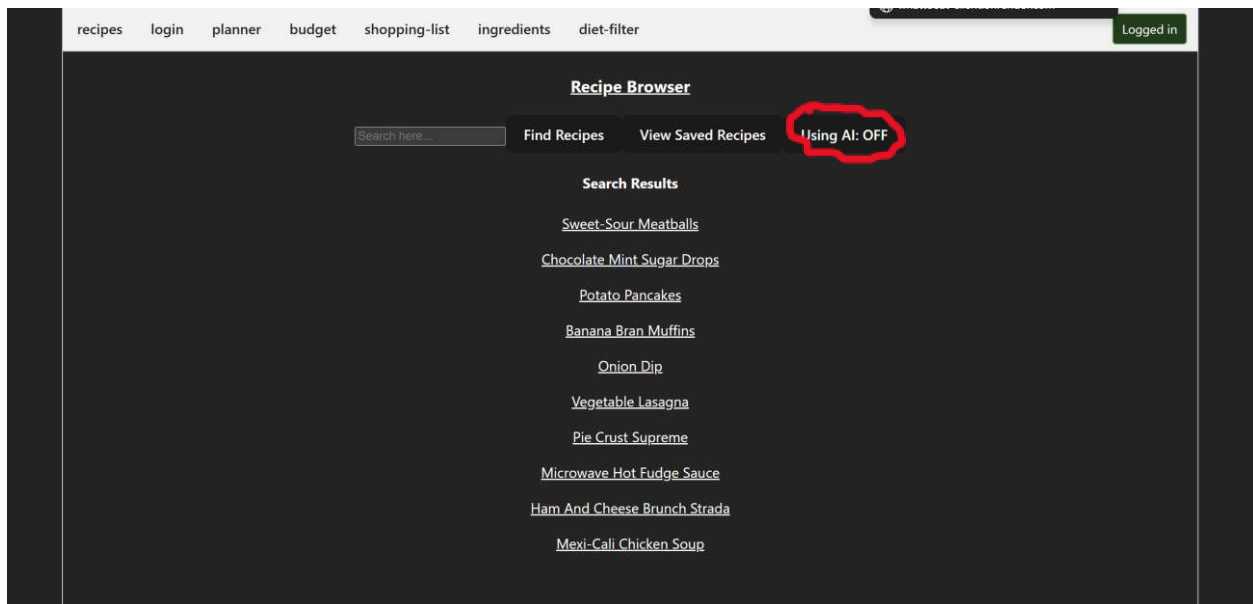
The image shows a dark-themed modal window titled "Edit Plan" with a close button (X) in the top right corner. Below the title is a subtitle: "Use the fields below to save or update the event." The form contains three input fields: "Food name" with the text "Pizza", "Date" with the text "05 / 04 / 2026" and a calendar icon, and "Time" with the text "12 : 00 PM" and a clock icon. At the bottom, there are three buttons: "Save" (dark grey), "Cancel" (light grey), and "Delete Plan" (red).

There is also a button next to “Plan Meal” to delete all past meals, so the user does not have to individually delete each plan. It is recommended to click this after every month since each user has a limited number of meal plans they can make to reduce resource consumption.

5 AI Recommendations-----

5.1 AI Button toggling

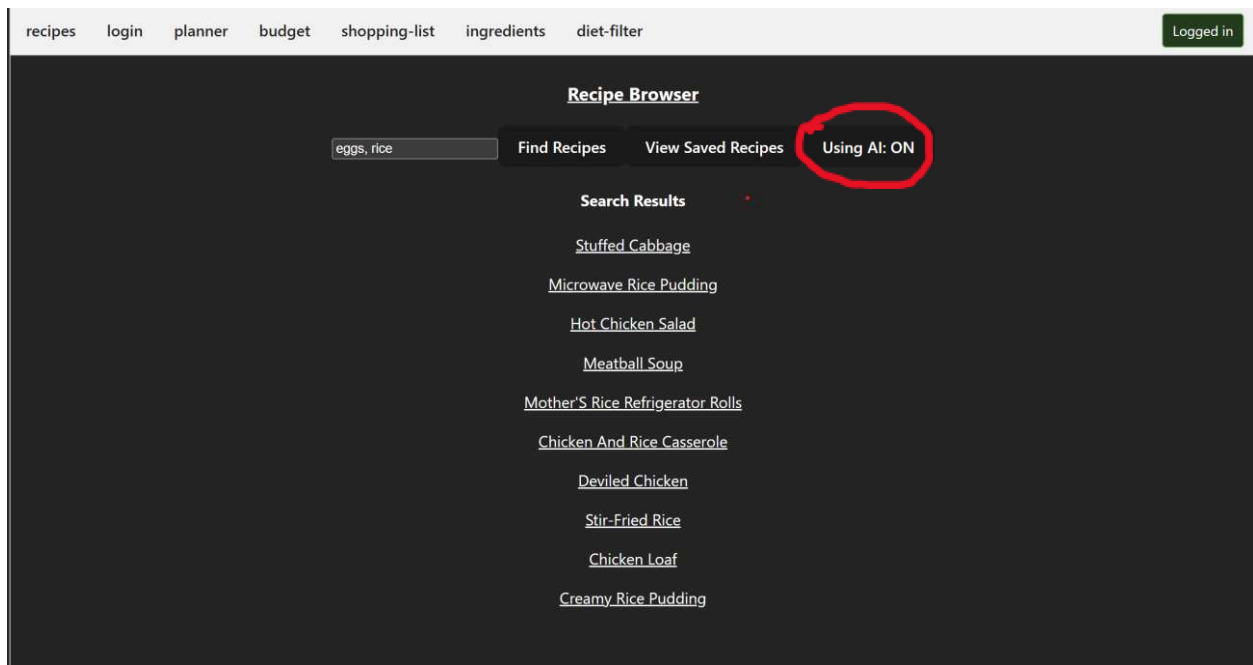
On the Recipes tab, there is a button that toggles the use of AI when getting recipes. When AI is turned off, the Find Recipes button will only use information from the recipe database when providing the list.



The Using AI button, when clicked, will toggle from Off to On (and vice versa if already on).

5.2 AI Selection

When the Using AI button is toggled to “On”, the app prompts Google Gemini based on your ingredient search selection, recipes available in our database, and your saved recipes. Using these criteria, the app uses AI to narrow down decision making to provide enhanced suitability to provided recipes.



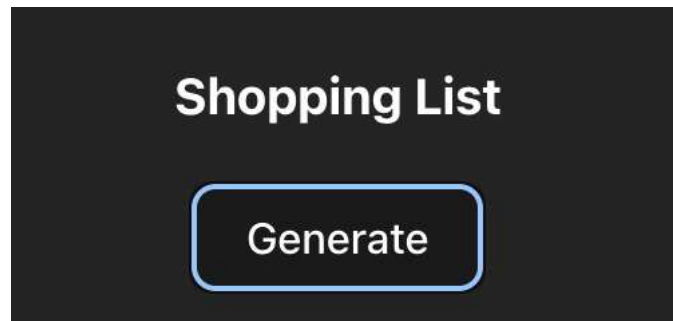
6 Shopping List-----

6.1 Shopping List Page

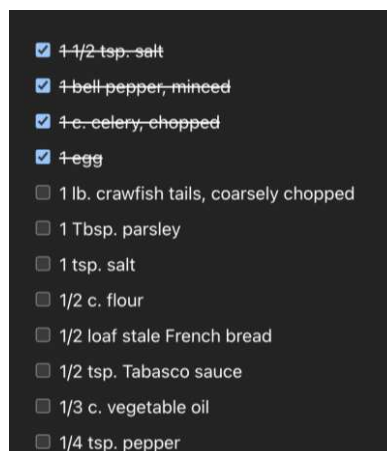
The shopping list feature is designed to compare the ingredients from the user's saved recipes (shown in section 2) with the ingredients that the user owns to generate a list of ingredients that they may need to purchase at a grocery store. Same as the other pages, the shopping list can be accessed by clicking on the "shopping-list" button at the top of the website.

6.2 Using the Shopping List

To generate the list of ingredients, the user can click the "Generate" button. If the user has no saved ingredients, then the list will not be able to generate, and "No ingredients found" may be displayed.



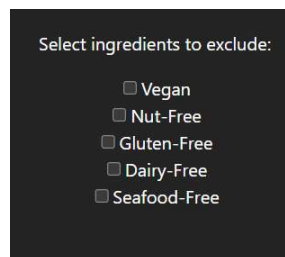
For example, after saving a few recipes, the shopping list looks like the below image, where the user can use it as a reference when grocery shopping, checking off ingredients as they go to keep track of exactly what they need and have already gotten.



7 Diet Filter-----

7.1 The Diet Filter Page

The Diet Filter page is accessed the same way as the others, by clicking and selecting the “diet-filter” tab. The filter page is designed to perform a specified search by using the filtering options that the user provided. When prompted to this page, there will be a selection of diet allergies/preferences in a checkbox style.

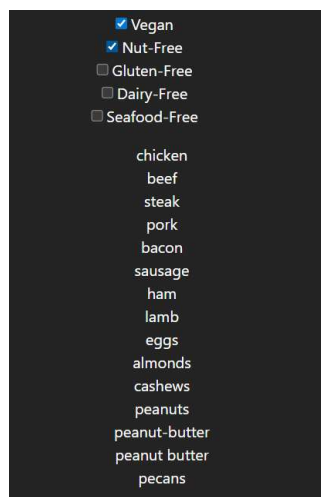


Select ingredients to exclude:

- ☐ Vegan
- ☐ Nut-Free
- ☐ Gluten-Free
- ☐ Dairy-Free
- ☐ Seafood-Free

7.2 Using the Dietary Filter

When the user selects the desired preference they want, the checkbox will return a series of ingredients that fall under the category of the selected checkbox, for example, if the user selects the “Vegan” checkbox, a series of meats that vegans cannot consume will be presented below. The user can select multiple checkboxes, and the series of ingredients will merge with each other to find recipes that do not contain any of the listed ingredients.



☒ Vegan
☒ Nut-Free
☐ Gluten-Free
☐ Dairy-Free
☐ Seafood-Free

- chicken
- beef
- steak
- pork
- bacon
- sausage
- ham
- lamb
- eggs
- almonds
- cashews
- peanuts
- peanut-butter
- peanut butter
- pecans

The user then selects the option to search for recipes, and the search will look for recipes that do not contain any ingredients that were under the users" selected checkbox.

8 Ingredient Tracker-----

8.1 The Ingredient Tracker Page

The ingredient tracker page can be accessed like all of the other pages, by pressing the “ingredients” button. The page allows the user to input the name of the ingredients they own, the amount of the ingredients, and the expiration date of the ingredient.

8.3 Using the Ingredient Tracker Page

To use the ingredient tracker input in the ingredient information, then click the “add to ingredient list” button.

The screenshot shows the 'Ingredient Tracker' page of a web application. At the top, there is a navigation bar with links: 'recipes', 'login', 'planner', 'budget', 'shopping-list', 'ingredients', and 'diet-filter'. The main content area has a dark background and is titled 'Ingredient Tracker'. It features a table with columns: 'Ingredient', 'Amount', 'Expiration date', and 'Add/Remove'. Below the table, there are two buttons: 'Save list' and 'Load list'. The table contains one row with the following data: 'chicken breast' in the 'Ingredient' column, '2' in the 'Amount' column, '05/06/2026' in the 'Expiration date' column, and a calendar icon in the 'Add/Remove' column. Below this row, there is a button labeled 'Add to ingredient list'. Below the table, there is another row with the following data: 'chicken breast' in the 'Ingredient' column, '2' in the 'Amount' column, '2026-05-06' in the 'Expiration date' column, and a button labeled 'remove Ingredient'.

Ingredient	Amount	Expiration date	Add/Remove
chicken breast	2	05/06/2026	
<button>Add to ingredient list</button>			
chicken breast	2	2026-05-06	<button>remove Ingredient</button>

After clicking the “add to ingredient list” button, the information will be added to the current list and appear on the menu. Ingredients are displayed in the order they are added. To remove an ingredient from the list, click the “remove ingredient” button next to the ingredient.

To access previously inputted data, click “Load list” after logging in. The saved data tied to the login will overwrite the current list. To save data, click “Save list” after logging in. This will overwrite the saved list with the current list. If either the load or save button is pressed before logging in, the current and saved list will remain unchanged, and an alert will be displayed.